Transitions — Part 2

Expression of Ideas · Reading and Writing · 97 questions

2.1 7ccaeef4-72d5-471c-854d-43f9b63de96b · Medium

Although those who migrated to California in 1849 dreamed of finding gold nuggets in streambeds, the state's richest deposits were buried deeply in rock, beyond the reach of individual prospectors. _____blank by 1852, many had given up their fortune-hunting dreams and gone to work for one of the large companies capable of managing California's complex mining operations.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Furthermore,

B. Still,

C. Consequently,

D. Next,

2.2 2c4d4984-16b3-4f55-ae49-6d5fa79b99cf · Medium

"Tulip mania"—the rapid rise and sudden fall of the price of tulip bulbs in seventeenth-century Amsterdam—is often cited as an example of the perils of rampant market speculation. However, recent research has demonstrated that the episode was neither as frenzied nor as disastrous as has been thought. The popular myth surrounding it, _____blank should be regarded with some skepticism.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. for example,

B. by contrast,

C. nevertheless,

D. therefore,

2.3 062b539c-799e-4ad4-921c-a3be44fcf2e8 · Medium

When, in the 1800s, geologists first realized that much of Earth had once been covered by great sheets of ice, some theorized that the phenomenon was cyclical, occurring at regular intervals. Each Ice Age is so destructive, though, that it largely erases the geological evidence of its predecessor. _____blank geologists were unable to confirm the theory of cyclical Ice Ages until the 1960s.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Hence,

B. Moreover,

C. Nevertheless,

D. Next,

2.4 509d7a25-06ba-4ee1-ac2f-74e178c744d2 · Medium

As the Proto-Indo-European language split into different languages, many words evolved to sound very different than they had in their proto-language—but this wasn't always the case. _____blank words retained much of their original sound. The word "father," for instance, sounds similar in Italian (padre), Latin (pater), and Sanskrit (pitar), three Proto-Indo-European descendants.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. Moreover,

C. Thus,

D. Sometimes,

2.5 5ed926eb-3044-40cb-8edd-c39c901a8b19 · Medium

In the early 1970s, Albert Popa took up graffiti art, spraying his work onto what was at the time an unconventional surface: concrete. _____blank Albert's son David has chosen an unusual canvas for his new art project, *Fractured*. In this remarkable work, the artist draws charcoal faces onto fragmented ice floes in Finland, creating the visual effect of a face slowly fracturing.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. Indeed,

C. Second,

D. Likewise,

2.6 ca657b0e-f012-43f4-a83e-4ab1fc4e2828 · Medium

To discover which fruit varieties were grown in Italy's Umbria region before the introduction of industrial farming, botanist Isabella Dalla Ragione often turns to centuries-old lists of cooking ingredients. _____blank she analyzes Renaissance paintings of Umbria, as they can provide accurate representations of fruits that were grown there long ago.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In sum,

B. Instead,

C. Thus,

D. Additionally,

2.7 6cd41d96-3454-462f-8b1b-c2293ecdbde2 · Medium

In November 1934, Amrita Sher-Gil was living in what must have seemed like the ideal city for a young artist: Paris. She was studying firsthand the color-saturated style of France's modernist masters and beginning to make a name for herself as a painter. _____blank Sher-Gil longed to return to her childhood home of India; only there, she believed, could her art truly flourish.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Still,

B. Therefore,

C. Indeed,

D. Furthermore,

2.8 45aaead0-9d12-46cb-bfc0-daf21dbeaeb5 · Medium

In 2018, Kurt Luther and Vikram Mohanty created the web-based tool Civil War Photo Sleuth (CWPS). A user uploading an unknown Civil War soldier's photograph to CWPS first tags the photo with all known information. _____blank CWPS's facial-recognition software analyzes twenty-seven different physical features and looks for matches to tagged images already in the database.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Then,

B. In fact,

C. Likewise,

D. For example,

2.9 8115a153-89bc-4bb9-93c8-b68bd4d76f43 · Medium

Imagine a magazine that a reader has thrown away. This magazine is post-consumer waste, as it became waste after reaching the consumer. _____blank the paper scraps left over from printing the magazine are pre-consumer waste, as they became waste before reaching the consumer.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By contrast,

B. For example,

C. As a result,

D. Specifically,

2.10 285e3025-d702-4d3b-a5f7-d9162ecdc5f7 · Medium

Archaeologist Sue Brunning explains why the seventh-century ship burial site at Sutton Hoo in England was likely the tomb of a king. First, the gold artifacts inside the ship suggest that the person buried with them was a wealthy and respected leader. _____blank the massive effort required to bury the ship would likely only have been undertaken for a king.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Instead,

B. Still,

C. Specifically,

D. Second,

2.11 234713d5-5d00-4aa4-9cc8-4dcba6c558c2 · Medium

Brain imaging research led by neuroscientist Dwaynica Greaves found that actors showed suppressed responses in the left anterior prefrontal cortex (the portion of the brain associated with self-awareness) when their names were called during performances; _____blank the actors' responses were normal in nonacting contexts. These findings suggest that when embodying characters, performers may temporarily set aside their personal identities.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. specifically,

B. conversely,

C. likewise,

D. thus,

2.12 361cfad2-26f4-4227-886d-d6f8b8d7147a · Medium

At two weeks old, the time their critical socialization period begins, wolves can smell but cannot yet see or hear. Domesticated dogs, _____blank can see, hear, and smell by the end of two weeks. This relative lack of sensory input may help explain why wolves behave so differently around humans than dogs do: from a very young age, wolves are more wary and less exploratory.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in other words,

B. for instance,

C. by contrast,

D. accordingly,

2.13 63f8c428-d75b-4220-a71a-2a7998892f80 · Medium

Alexander Lawrence Posey (1873–1908) varied his focus and tone depending on the genre in which he was writing. In his poetry, he used heartfelt language to evoke the beauty and peacefulness of his natural surroundings; in his journalism, _____blank he employed humor and satire to comment on political issues affecting his Muskogee Creek community.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. that is,

B. granted,

C. similarly,

D. by contrast,

2.14 93751b2c-f263-4e49-91bb-3afc830dc6fd · Medium

Jeffrey Gibson's sculptural object *KNOW YOUR MAGIC, BABY,* an Everlast-brand exercise bag embroidered with multicolored beads and a fringe associated with the dances of the Ojibwe people, stitches together—literally and figuratively—recognizable symbols from both Native and non-Native cultures. _____blank Gibson's piece also blurs the distinction between contemporary art and traditional crafts.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Conversely,

B. In so doing,

C. For instance,

D. In particular,

2.15 7f3e3df2-29e5-4d5b-8f57-55a29038ced2 · Medium

In his painting *At the Cycle-Race Track*, Jean Metzinger aims to depict a bike race in four-dimensional space. Of course, Metzinger's painting doesn't technically represent a fourth dimension; humans can only see in three dimensions. _____blank by depicting the race through multiple, simultaneous perspectives, Metzinger offers a fascinating glimpse at what this other universe might look like.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Moreover,

B. That said,

C. In other words,

D. For example,

2.16 c8cd8993-74e1-4208-a541-f35ff4dbfeda · Medium

Establishing Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) is no easy task. Each month, readings of a single second from atomic clocks around the world are taken and sent to the International Bureau of Weights and Measures (BIPM) in France. _____blank BIPM metrologists perform the meticulous work of assembling these minutely disparate readings into a globally shared time standard.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. There,

B. In particular,

C. For example,

D. Conversely,

2.17 cc59c3a6-c63d-42cd-bc64-889005894301 · Medium

Some members of the US Supreme Court have resisted calls to televise the court's oral arguments, concerned that the participants would be tempted to perform for the cameras (and thus lower the quality of the discourse). _____blank the justices worry that most viewers would not even watch the full deliberations, only short clips that could be misinterpreted and mischaracterized.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. Additionally,

C. In comparison,

D. For example,

2.18 0bb1ffab-6a9a-4161-9e7c-65334c8df9ba · Medium

The Coastal Futures Conservatory in Virginia is known for creating aural representations of ecological data. One such effort combines underwater audio recorded in seagrass beds with data that track rising carbon levels in the seagrass. As carbon levels increase, the audio is correspondingly distorted; _____blank listeners can "hear" the changes in the carbon levels.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. furthermore,

B. by comparison,

C. for instance,

D. thus,

2.19 293b55b8-49d6-42e6-b03d-5f4ecc052dc3 · Medium

When, in 2017, Cambridge University students Lucy Moss and Toby Marlow decided they wanted to develop a musical together, one of their goals was for their female actor friends to have good parts to play. _____blank they created the show *Six*, a retelling of the history of King Henry VIII's wives in which each of the six queens has a starring role.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In other words,

B. In summary,

C. For example,

D. To that end,

2.20 9b3cf440-7790-49d1-a3c2-47a194d3c749 · Medium

Following the American Revolutionary War, North American foodways underwent a radical transformation, fueled in large part by spiking consumer demand for certain grains. The cultivation, trade, and transportation of maize and wheat, _____blank reconfigured the continent's existing regional foodways into a globally oriented food system.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in particular,

B. alternatively,

C. by comparison,

D. second of all,

2.21 277fb947-e7d2-4316-bcef-a79554eb9a08 · Medium

Scientists long debated the origins of chondrules, tiny glass beads that formed in meteors billions of years ago. For decades, different theories were proposed, from lightning strikes to powerful rock collisions, but none had sufficient evidentiary support. _____blank scientists found strong evidence that chondrules were formed by shock waves in nearby nebulae.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For example,

B. Therefore,

C. Similarly,

D. Finally,

2.22 dfe91e9e-0f76-4130-80c1-8a8a439b700d · Medium

Topographic maps show the elevation of landforms above sea level. Bathymetric maps, _____blank show the elevation of landforms below the sea, providing valuable information to marine geophysicists like Claudia Flores, who studies seismic data from the northeastern Caribbean.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in conclusion,

B. for example,

C. by contrast,

D. afterward,

2.23 eb908c22-f0e5-4e8e-a74a-9e02f9aaf2e1 · Medium

In 1933, the Twentieth Amendment to the US Constitution was ratified. The amendment mandates that presidential inaugurations be held on January 20, approximately ten weeks after the November election. _____blank this amendment requires newly elected US senators and representatives to be sworn into their respective offices on January 3.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Instead,

B. For instance,

C. Specifically,

D. In addition,

2.24 442ba363-c324-4677-a1b4-a634b4191a8d · Medium

With his room-sized installation *Unicorn/My Private Sky*, Norwegian artist Børre Sæthre succeeds in creating a whimsical yet perplexing experience. _____blank when visitors set foot inside the fantastically blue room and encounter the life-sized stuffed unicorn preening at the far end of it, they are both dazzled and confused—as if stepping into a strange and enchanting new world.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Second,

B. Instead,

C. Indeed,

D. Nevertheless,

2.25 db7f27c9-80b1-4168-9dda-b415c1979457 · Medium

For years, biologists have experimented with using grime-eating bacteria rather than harsh chemicals to clean artworks, and results have been impressive overall. _____blank these bacterial strains—which can metabolize centuries' worth of oil, glue, dirt, and other surface impurities without creating harmful byproducts—have proven more effective than traditional chemical cleaning methods.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. In many cases,

C. As a result,

D. Additionally,

2.26 caa9e207-e30f-41ec-b353-c35b7b9b9175 · Medium

Mary Ellen Pleasant, a successful entrepreneur during the gold rush era, earned the moniker "Mother of Human Rights in California" after successfully challenging discrimination in the state. _____blank in 1866, she sued a streetcar company for denying her and other Black riders service, a suit she eventually won when the California Supreme Court declared it illegal for carriers to exclude passengers based on race.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For this reason,

B. Then,

C. In addition,

D. Specifically,

2.27 55990205-1650-49d6-925b-5ca9a3c1a14b · Medium

Earth's auroras—colorful displays of light seen above the northern and southern poles—result, broadly speaking, from the Sun's activity. _____blank the Sun releases charged particles that are captured by Earth's magnetic field and channeled toward the poles. These particles then collide with atoms in the atmosphere, causing the atoms to emit auroral light.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Specifically,

B. Similarly,

C. Nevertheless,

D. Hence,

2.28 659659ad-43c6-4be1-9e53-5f5814d3c4e9 · Medium

Jhumpa Lahiri's story collection *Interpreter of Maladies* features multiple stories about romantic relationships. In "This Blessed House," newlyweds argue over whether to replace items left by the previous owners of their new home. _____blank in "A Temporary Matter," a husband and wife attempt to rekindle their relationship during a four-night blackout.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Granted,

B. For example,

C. Likewise,

D. Hence,

2.29 f0168aca-49ba-46ea-984f-c7b7cff2bd53 · Medium

In her 2012 analysis of tree rings from Japan's Yaku Island, cosmic ray physicist Fusa Miyake noted an anomalous carbon-14 spike dating to 774–775 CE, indicating that a massive burst of radiation reached Earth during that time. _____blank this unprecedented radiocarbon surge was dubbed a "Miyake event" in honor of its discoverer.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Fittingly,

B. Similarly,

C. However,

D. In other words,

2.30 c8726d4a-0baa-4c7c-a1b5-9351e4a4832d · Medium

In the 1880s, inventor Lewis Latimer improved upon Thomas Edison's design for the electric light bulb. _____blank Latimer made the light bulb more durable by placing cardboard around its carbon filament. With this innovation, Latimer became the first Black inventor to contribute to the electrification of the world.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Soon,

B. Regardless,

C. However,

D. Specifically,

2.31 ce846d6a-1094-4244-a4b0-8eeb2638fd10 · Medium

In 2021, a model developed by astrophysicist Catherine Zucker and her research team revealed that the same supernovas responsible for the creation and ongoing expansion of the Local Bubble—a 14-million-year-old cavity in the Milky Way—are likely responsible for the formation of new stars. _____blank this model detailed how the bubble's expansion trapped interstellar clouds of gas and dust that became stars upon their eventual collapse.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Hence,

B. However,

C. Admittedly,

D. Specifically,

2.32 4338630c-fbdc-4eb4-becf-2800b705feb6 · Medium

Most of the planets that have been discovered outside our solar system orbit G-type stars, like our Sun. In 2014, _____blank researchers identified a planet orbiting KELT-9, a B-type star more than twice as massive and nearly twice as hot as the Sun. Called KELT-9b, it is one of the hottest planets ever discovered.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. likewise,

B. however,

C. therefore,

D. for example,

2.33 557b744d-7231-424e-af00-30e5d4008971 · Medium

In 1873, Spanish scientist Santiago Ramón y Cajal observed that brain fibers have distinct boundaries with clear end points, a finding that went against earlier assumptions about the brain. _____blank scientists had assumed that the brain was a continuous web of fused fibers, not a vast network of distinct, individual cells.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. Previously,

C. As a result,

D. Likewise,

2.34 138f38d9-26dd-40bc-b574-aea013f78b27 · Medium

Working together with the Navajo Nation Department of Water Resources, Dr. Lani Tsinnajinnie analyzed data about snowpack levels in the Chuska Mountains. She found that the snowpack (the amount of snow on the ground) was deepest in early March at lower elevations. At higher elevations, _____blank the snowpack was deepest in mid-March.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in other words,

B. for instance,

C. on the other hand,

D. in summary,

2.35 395ba0d7-8eca-4940-b2a1-bb99f39b6343 · Medium

With its clichéd imagery of suburban lawns and power lines, John Ashbery's 2004 poem "Ignorance of the Law Is No Excuse" may seem barren terrain for critical analysis. _____blank cultural critic Lauren Berlant finds fertile ground in just its first two stanzas, devoting most of a book chapter to deciphering the "weight of the default space" Ashbery creates in this poem.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Likewise,

B. Nonetheless,

C. In turn,

D. That is,

2.36 f80e6575-2260-46c2-8732-dbf41d55a025 · Medium

The Babylonian king Hammurabi achieved much during his forty-year reign. He conquered all of Mesopotamia and built Babylon into one of the most powerful cities of the ancient world. Today, _____blank he is mainly remembered for a code of laws inscribed on a seven-foot-tall block of stone: the Code of Hammurabi.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. therefore,

B. likewise,

C. however,

D. for instance,

2.37 095d7a95-3728-4e55-89db-906ff9d16063 · Medium

On a chilly spring morning in a Virginia park, as sunlight crested the treetops, Kathrin Swoboda raised her Nikon D500 camera and captured an image that would win the Grand Prize in the 2019 Audubon Photography Awards: a red-winged blackbird, exhaling what appeared to be rings of smoke. _____blank the "smoke" was actually the blackbird's breath hitting the cold morning air as the bird sang.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Furthermore,

B. For example,

C. Therefore,

D. Of course,

2.38 5092086e-9e04-41e3-be32-ea196b3e50e7 · Medium

With her room-sized installation *The Interstitium*, Iranian American artist Laleh Mehran succeeded in creating a space that felt, as intended, both "familiar and distant." _____blank with a video screen placed at the far end of the coal slag-encrusted room, her installation was reminiscent of a typical movie theater—albeit one found in a subterranean coal mine.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Next,

B. Nevertheless,

C. Indeed,

D. Instead,

2.39 53e572cc-c894-48ae-af49-0a8c3262b1a6 · Medium

Researchers Helena Mihaljević-Brandt, Lucía Santamaría, and Marco Tullney report that while mathematicians may have traditionally worked alone, evidence points to a shift in the opposite direction. _____blank mathematicians are choosing to collaborate with their peers—a trend illustrated by a rise in the number of mathematics publications credited to multiple authors.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Similarly,

B. For this reason,

C. Furthermore,

D. Increasingly,

2.40 075003df-5e06-4b3f-88b4-1a859b06ea0d · Medium

Al-Andalus, the historical region of the Iberian Peninsula that includes most of modern-day Spain, was ruled by various Arabic-speaking Muslim states between the eighth and fifteenth centuries. _____blank many Arabic words, such as “alacrán”—meaning “scorpion”—made their way into the Spanish language.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For example,

B. Instead,

C. Specifically,

D. Consequently,

2.41 38da0806-db4c-4d38-a6fd-65fd8d2824fc · Medium

While studying jorō spiders, a large species originally from East Asia, University of Georgia researchers wondered if the spiders' rapid spread throughout the southeastern US was a result of aggressive behavior. _____blank they discovered that jorō spiders are gentle giants who react to even minor disturbances by "freezing" in place for an hour or more.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Therefore,

B. Instead,

C. For example,

D. In other words,

2.42 92ac4e77-7550-41a8-904a-3d05282459a0 · Medium

As Iestyn Barr and his team of researchers discovered when establishing the glacial timeline of Antarctica, the Transantarctic Mountains—a 3,500-km mountain range spanning the continent—are home to glaciers of at least 60 million years in age. _____blank the researchers concluded, Antarctica had glaciers long before the formation of its continent-wide ice sheet 34 million years ago.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By contrast,

B. Thus,

C. Nevertheless,

D. Even so,

2.43 4d4c8dd9-5100-47fc-b73a-cd0e64a682fb · Medium

Scientists were able to isolate a relatively pure sample of selenium in 1817, the same year they first discovered the element's existence. _____blank the isolation process took longer for molybdenum, which was isolated in its pure form three years after scientists first discovered it.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By contrast,

B. Thus,

C. Similarly,

D. For instance,

2.44 a0d52b5d-8503-42b3-a30f-685beeea0d92 · Medium

The Inca of South America used intricately knotted string devices called quipus to record countable information, like population data and payments. _____blank they may have used quipus to record more complex information, like stories and myths, according to researchers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. As a result,

B. In other words,

C. In addition,

D. For example,

2.45 effb864f-3000-48f7-9ccc-b05ed09a2529 · Medium

Originally coined by economist Joan Robinson to refer to markets with multiple sellers of a product but only one buyer, the term “monopsony” can also refer to markets where demand for labor is limited. In a product monopsony, the single buyer can force sellers to lower their prices. _____blank in a labor monopsony, employers can force workers to accept lower wages.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Earlier,

B. Instead,

C. Similarly,

D. In particular,

2.46 fa2d1a26-46bd-490d-8fe1-30454adad22a · Medium

Riley Black—the author of critically acclaimed books such as *My Beloved Brontosaurus* (2013)—is best known for writing about dinosaurs, but she has also conducted hands-on fieldwork. _____blank her fieldwork has included paleontological digs in Utah, Montana, and Wyoming, and her dinosaur fossil discoveries can be seen at places such as the Carnegie Museum of Natural History.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Regardless,

B. Subsequently,

C. Specifically,

D. Conversely,

2.47 61e4987d-fb06-4147-acf3-d01a7f3b36f2 · Medium

My interest in old public libraries has led me to seek them out whenever I visit a new part of the United States. _____blank I could visit every state in the US and still not find the oldest public library in the Western Hemisphere. That library, the Biblioteca Palafoxiana, is located in Puebla, Mexico.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. As a result,

B. Nevertheless,

C. Earlier,

D. In other words,

2.48 488f2a13-c361-4378-acf9-b34bbb6267c4 · Medium

The more diverse and wide ranging an animal's behaviors, the larger and more energy demanding the animal's brain tends to be. _____blank from an evolutionary perspective, animals that perform only basic actions should allocate fewer resources to growing and maintaining brain tissue. The specialized subtypes of ants within colonies provide an opportunity to explore this hypothesis.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Subsequently,

B. Besides,

C. Nevertheless,

D. Thus,

2.49 4042856b-e301-43f6-8cb7-495dda0e51c4 · Medium

Award-winning travel writer Linda Watanabe McFerrin considers the background research she conducts on destinations featured in her travel books to be its own reward. _____blank McFerrin admits to finding the research phase of her work just as fascinating and engaging as exploring a location in person.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By contrast,

B. Likewise,

C. Besides,

D. In fact,

2.50 5401b4e3-2d70-43a2-b7df-384959606a0f · Medium

“Wishcycling”—putting nonrecyclable items into recycling bins under the mistaken belief that those items can be recycled—ultimately does more harm than good. Nonrecyclable items, such as greasy pizza boxes, can contaminate recyclable materials, rendering entire batches unusable. _____blank nonrecyclable products can damage recycling plants’ machinery.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Fittingly,

B. On the contrary,

C. Moreover,

D. Nevertheless,

2.51 4be7caa8-e069-4346-af6c-a5ba998eeef5 · Medium

With their distinctive cone shapes and steeply sloping sides, the volcanoes Hverfjall (Iceland) and Toliman (Guatemala) may look similar from afar. Tehnuka Ilanko and other volcanologists, _____blank can tell by how each was formed that Hverfjall is a cinder cone volcano, while Toliman is a composite volcano.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. for example,

B. in addition,

C. therefore,

D. though,

2.52 42c9687e-7cf5-4c09-8d7b-488a5a1e1fe1 · Medium

A firefly uses specialized muscles to draw oxygen into its lower abdomen through narrow tubes, triggering a chemical reaction whereby the oxygen combines with chemicals in the firefly's abdomen to produce a glow. _____blank when the firefly stops drawing in oxygen, the reaction—and the glow—cease.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For instance,

B. By contrast,

C. Specifically,

D. In conclusion,

2.53 76757b39-2317-4b33-8831-07a58aa322fc · Medium

Researchers believe that pieces of hull found off Oregon's coast are from a Spanish cargo ship that was lost in 1697. Stories passed down among the area's Confederated Tribes of Siletz Indians support this belief. _____blank Siletz stories describe how blocks of beeswax, an item the ship had been carrying, began washing ashore after the ship was lost.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For this reason,

B. For example,

C. However,

D. Likewise,

2.54 0af1f07f-515d-4d25-a257-5bb272b64aa8 · Medium

Despite its great distance from Earth—it is 570 light-years away—the star Shaula is one of the brightest stars in the sky, ranking 23rd. Although not as bright as Shaula, the star Alkaid also ranks among the 50 brightest stars (40th, to be exact). _____blank Alkaid's brightness is likely due to the star's relative proximity: Alkaid is only 100 light-years from Earth.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Indeed,

B. As a result,

C. Granted,

D. Similarly,

2.55 97d2384c-d243-41cf-b968-fe81df7675a7 · Medium

Before California's 1911 election to approve a proposition granting women the right to vote, activists across the state sold tea to promote the cause of suffrage. In San Francisco, the Woman's Suffrage Party sold Equality Tea at local fairs. _____blank in Los Angeles, activist Nancy Tuttle Craig, who ran one of California's largest grocery store firms, distributed Votes for Women Tea.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For example,

B. To conclude,

C. Similarly,

D. In other words,

2.56 c8957ff2-9674-47a3-a4d1-718331694c42 · Medium

Biographer Michael Gorra notes that the novelist Henry James "lived in a world of second thoughts," frequently tinkering with his novels and stories after their initial publication. However, the differences between the 1881 first edition and the 1908 edition of his novel *A Portrait of a Lady* are extreme, even by James's standards; _____blank some critics regard the two editions as two different novels altogether.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. by contrast,

B. in fact,

C. nevertheless,

D. in other words,

2.57 4a0e7481-a0e1-4b5c-9fde-d9ecfa15f63f · Hard

Magnetic levitation (maglev) trains are suspended above a track by powerful electromagnets, reducing friction and thus allowing for much faster speeds. Though maglev advocates in the US have long imagined these trains crisscrossing the country, their dream remains unrealized. _____blank of the handful of maglev trains currently in operation, all are in Asia.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In fact,

B. To that end,

C. Nevertheless,

D. That said,

2.58 161725f0-8529-45c1-bf18-5df4d261b7b5 · Hard

Historically, most conductors of major orchestras and opera companies have been European men, but a new, more diverse generation of artists is stepping up to the podium. Mexico's Alondra de la Parra took over as conductor for the Queensland Symphony Orchestra in 2017, _____blank and Colombia's Lina Gonzalez-Granados did the same for the Los Angeles Opera in 2022.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in addition,

B. lastly,

C. granted,

D. for instance,

2.59 df76975a-66c8-4cfc-b5fe-e06b2abc542c · Hard

To perform a quad axel, a figure skater must leap into the air and complete four and a half rotations before landing, an extreme feat. _____blank in 2022, when 17-year-old Ilia Malinin landed the first quad axel—considered the most difficult quad jump—in a high-level competition, the audience was left awestruck.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Moreover,

B. Fittingly,

C. Next,

D. However,

2.60 5f5a1b2c-faa5-422e-a8fa-1db3b693a78e · Hard

The prime meridian, the global indicator of zero degrees longitude established in 1884, was originally determined using astronomically derived coordinates. _____blank as decades passed, new calculations would reveal increasingly precise coordinates, yet the prime meridian remained unchanged; it wasn't until the 1980s that, spurred by improved geodetic data, the prime meridian was officially moved—roughly one hundred meters east.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Specifically,

B. To that end,

C. Again and again,

D. Granted,

2.61 ba254f3b-4864-4414-bb3d-2331683558d7 · Hard

Upon first approaching artist Kurt Wenner's *Dies Irae*, a colorful scene painted on the surface of a cobblestone street in Mantua, Italy, one might assume a deep hole filled with life-sized, classically styled sculptures had opened up in the street. _____blank by expertly applying the principles of perspective, Wenner created merely the illusion of depth.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Additionally,

B. On the contrary,

C. As a result,

D. Next,

2.62 23e256e6-fc68-4151-865c-6bee9f3922b5 · Hard

In retrospect, one of the lessons of the 2003 Human Genome Project is that a gene is affected by many factors, not the least of which is its interactions with the protein products of other genes. _____blank rather than just focusing on the human genome, efforts to better understand gene mutations related to disease have begun to consider the human proteome, the complete set of proteins expressed by human genes.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In other words,

B. That said,

C. For example,

D. Accordingly,

2.63 58f0d5dd-524c-4f61-aa40-f10f19bbc0c2 · Hard

Mountain climbing routes that incorporate metal rungs and cables are known as via ferratas, from the Italian phrase for “iron path.” As climbing these routes has shifted from a mode of travel to a sporting activity, modern via ferratas are rarely designed to simply reach a summit. _____blank new routes favor recreation over utility, aiming to provide a challenging climb or showcase dramatic scenery.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Additionally,

B. On the other hand,

C. More often,

D. Nonetheless,

2.64 bcd3e56f-c9a6-4627-a402-65710bf36530 · Hard

In her poetry collection *Thomas and Beulah*, Rita Dove interweaves the titular characters’ personal stories with broader historical narratives. She places Thomas’s journey from the American South to the Midwest in the early 1900s within the larger context of the Great Migration. _____blank Dove sets events from Beulah’s personal life against the backdrop of the US Civil Rights Movement.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Specifically,

B. Thus,

C. Regardless,

D. Similarly,

2.65 54d57f5e-7d9a-4185-9a93-a5c476e4564a · Hard

When one looks at the dark craggy vistas in Hitoshi Fugo's evocative photo series, one's mind might wander off to the cratered surfaces of faraway planets. _____blank it's the series' title, *Flying Frying Pan*, that brings one back to Earth, reminding the viewer that each photo is actually a close-up view of a familiar household object: a frying pan.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Consequently,

B. Alternatively,

C. Ultimately,

D. Additionally,

2.66 07f9c472-31de-4d81-91c5-b0e774ff7102 · Hard

In Asiya Wadud's 2022 poem "Shorn, Treaded Red," the poet contemplates a painting that has inspired her: Etel Adnan's 2020 work *Satellites 27*. The painting, which features overlapping geometric shapes, fuels the poem's exploration of temporality and identity. _____blank in responding to Adnan's artwork, Wadud's poem reflects on the relationship between poetry and other art forms.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In other words,

B. For instance,

C. What's more,

D. Conversely,

2.67 63081b48-0053-4166-9736-642c83892256 · Hard

In 2009, the Craft and Folk Art Museum in Los Angeles hosted a special exhibition, *Sueños/Yume,* showcasing the works of local sculptor Dora de Larios. As suggested by the show's title (*sueños* and *yume* mean "dreams" in Spanish and Japanese, respectively), de Larios's art reflects a mix of cultural influences. _____blank her work is grounded in the artistic traditions of both Mexico and Japan.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In addition,

B. In contrast,

C. Specifically,

D. Therefore,

2.68 40cd4527-607a-45e3-9a50-6a0ea2e01c33 · Hard

In *Color Charts: A History* (2024), anthropologist Anne Varichon uses vivid prose to describe various systems and tools that have been used over the past few centuries for categorizing colors. _____blank Varichon's book features many high-quality images of these color presentation tools—from fanlike arrangements of hued fabric swatches to clusters of dyed feathers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Consequently,

B. Additionally,

C. That said,

D. Specifically,

2.69 76e2e40a-bfbf-49b0-8edb-a22d307c58c2 · Hard

The mineral mtorolite is most commonly found in Zimbabwe. Mtorolite is cryptocrystalline, meaning that its crystalline structure is so fine that the individual crystals cannot be distinguished by the naked eye or even under a microscope. The crystals in microcrystalline minerals are also not visible to the naked eye; _____blank they can usually be seen under a microscope.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. thus,

B. for example,

C. that said,

D. similarly,

2.70 b65ede14-ac4e-4dd8-8b53-58d5ed2a89e7 · Hard

Because an achiral molecule is symmetrical, flipping it yields a structurally identical molecule. A flipped chiral molecule, _____blank can be compared to a glove that has been turned inside out: it produces a structurally inverted molecule rather than an identical one.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in other words,

B. by contrast,

C. for example,

D. similarly,

2.71 475f0dde-a4ec-4f91-b2b4-de36e7b1a6ca · Hard

In hindsight, given the ideas about the natural world circulating among British scientists in the 1800s, the theory of natural selection was an obvious next step. It may not have been a coincidence, _____blank that Charles Darwin and Alfred Wallace arrived at the concept independently. Indeed, contrary to the popular myth of the lone genius, theirs is not the first paradigm-shifting theory to have emerged from multiple scholars working in parallel.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. however,

B. then,

C. moreover,

D. for example,

2.72 a2f6277c-a89c-4a0f-b14a-5e4ddc3e2148 · Hard

Seismologists Kaiqing Yuan and Barbara Romanowicz have proposed that the magma fueling Iceland's more than 30 active volcano systems emerges from deep within Earth. The great depths involved—nearly 3,000 km—mark Iceland's volcanoes as extreme outliers; _____blank many of Earth's volcanoes are fed by shallow pockets of magma found less than 15 km below the surface.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. indeed,

B. nevertheless,

C. in addition,

D. consequently,

2.73 5819db8d-3b25-4301-9883-734b8adcf8c1 · Hard

One proposed boundary between Earth's atmosphere and outer space is the Kármán line, 100 km above sea level. Based on the work of physicist Theodore von Kármán, this line marks the theoretical height at which an aircraft no longer remains aloft using the force of lift. _____blank an aircraft sustains flight past this altitude primarily by its velocity, reaching a speed sufficient to maintain an orbit but not to generate enough lift from the thin air.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For instance,

B. Instead,

C. Granted,

D. Regardless,

2.74 330ea545-cb02-4e1a-a12b-6bb6afc1c7fe · Hard

A 2017 study of sign language learners tested the role of iconicity—the similarity of a sign to the thing it represents—in language acquisition. The study found that the greater the iconicity of a sign, the more likely it was to have been learned. _____blank the correlation between acquisition and iconicity was lower than that between acquisition and another factor studied: sign frequency.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In fact,

B. In other words,

C. Granted,

D. As a result,

2.75 653bea66-a999-4d76-aa42-cf889190148d · Hard

In Annie Dillard's *Pilgrim at Tinker Creek*—where, early on, the author marvels at a single goldfish's delicate fins but later winces when imagining a horde of goldfish laying and eating their own eggs—Dillard struggles to reconcile the complicated juxtapositions of the natural world. _____blank nature's mesmerizing intricacy and pitiless harshness prove inextricably linked for Dillard, like "two branches of the same creek."

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. To that end,

B. Ultimately,

C. Moreover,

D. Hence,

2.76 9e08e07b-a735-4642-a734-819ff9d186dc · Hard

In response to adverse environmental conditions, many plants produce abscisic acid (ABA), a stress hormone. ABA triggers a slowdown in the biological processes of most plants. _____blank when the mustard plant *Schrenkiella parvula* produces ABA in response to an environmental stressor, the hormone triggers accelerated growth.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Moreover,

B. In contrast,

C. For example,

D. Thus,

2.77 da4cc4a1-6629-4e12-816b-51ec812fa6c1 · Hard

Charles Demuth's 1931 painting *Chimney and Water Tower* is a classic Precisionist work. The Precisionists strove for cold, machine-like perfection, with crisp lines, geometric shapes, and smooth, brushstroke-free surfaces. _____blank Precisionist works often feature skyscrapers, bridges, and factories, highlighting these angular structures' engineered symmetry.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Accordingly,

B. In the end,

C. That said,

D. However,

2.78 c8593e14-0f20-473c-803a-5ea66e1777a3 · Hard

The Madison is a type of line dance that involves neat rows of dancers performing a repeated sequence of steps in unison. _____blank many other dances are also defined by order, repetition, and synchronicity, but the Madison is distinguished by its extreme uniformity; when an auditorium full of dancers performs the Madison, one almost gets the impression of a military march.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. However,

B. Of course,

C. Specifically,

D. Moreover,

2.79 5c88c6f7-538c-495b-b746-e9ba2be11495 · Hard

When printing paper money for the colony of Pennsylvania in the 1730s, Benjamin Franklin—then a Philadelphia shop owner—took steps to combat the circulation of counterfeit notes, such as weaving blue threads and muscovite (a reflective mineral) into the paper he used. _____blank he stamped the notes with detailed imprints of sage leaves that proved difficult for forgers to replicate.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Specifically,

B. That said,

C. For example,

D. Moreover,

2.80 9467e8c0-5715-4578-949a-d66ad4e1aa78 · Hard

Ugandan American professor Peter Nazareth believed that Elvis Presley's music is best understood not as a homogeneous collection but as an anthology (because Elvis showcased the contributions of a wide range of gospel, blues, and rock artists). _____blank Nazareth entitled his college course on Elvis and his music, which focused on Elvis's many musical influences, "Elvis as Anthology."

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. To that end,

B. In sum,

C. That is,

D. In addition,

2.81 95351918-250d-4833-a66c-453eebf233c6 · Hard

When soil becomes contaminated by toxic metals, it can be removed from the ground and disposed of in a landfill. _____blank contaminated soil can be detoxified via phytoremediation: plants that can withstand high concentrations of metals absorb the pollutants and store them in their shoots, which are then cut off and safely disposed of, preserving the health of the plants.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Alternatively,

B. Specifically,

C. For example,

D. As a result,

2.82 fa45fdd1-8a89-477b-be0c-783d930d6e6b · Hard

Economist Elinor Ostrom's studies of communities around the world have empirically demonstrated that common pool resources, such as grazing lands, can be sustainably managed by the people who use them (rather than through private entities or centralized governments). _____blank Ostrom's work is a repudiation of the "tragedy of the commons," the view that individuals will inevitably overexploit a finite shared resource if given unfettered access to it.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By contrast,

B. For example,

C. That said,

D. As such,

2.83 7c141757-c5fa-480a-8a3c-87b8746c8d3b · Hard

In astrophysics, a ring of debris orbiting a larger object within the object's Roche limit is expected to persist as a ring, whereas a ring of debris orbiting outside this limit would likely accrete into a satellite (e.g., a moon). Bruno Morgado and colleagues, _____blank detected a dense ring of material orbiting the trans-Neptunian object Quaoar at a distance of 2,500 miles, well outside the calculated Roche limit of 1,100 miles, that has remained intact.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. though,

B. for example,

C. fittingly,

D. likewise,

2.84 4ed2b7c1-cbad-481a-9974-80cdb6245839 · Hard

Upper-atmospheric jets—phenomena whereby electrical discharges cause narrow cones of blue light to briefly burst upward from the tops of thunderclouds—have been observed reaching the ionosphere. The extreme altitudes involved (the ionosphere begins about 80 km above Earth) mark these gigantic jets as outliers; _____blank the majority of jets reach heights of only 20 to 50 km.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. nevertheless,

B. consequently,

C. indeed,

D. in addition,

2.85 dd3a2765-6d7e-4fe3-8c96-e7f4418482ad · Hard

A turtle shell appears external to the animal, protecting its body like armor. _____blank the shell is often incorrectly assumed to be an exoskeleton, a rigid outer casing like that of a crustacean or an insect, when in fact it is an endoskeleton, a part of the turtle's internal bone structure, more akin to a spine or a pair of ribs.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. That being said,

B. However,

C. For instance,

D. Hence,

2.86 1b4693c2-1b84-4523-9e60-3a6012410a7d · Hard

In his 2023 collection *The Diaspora Sonnets*, Filipino American poet Oliver de la Paz leverages the sonnet form's "diamond-like quality of precision," as he describes it. The poems often adhere scrupulously to the form's centuries-old conventions, such as its characteristic fourteen-line length. In the twelve-line poem "Diaspora Sonnet at the Feeders Before the Freeze," _____blank de la Paz playfully subverts sonnet conventions, the poem's truncated length conveying a sense of abruptness.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. fittingly,

B. similarly,

C. for example,

D. by contrast,

2.87 74f4478d-92d2-4a5a-a41b-76bbd45f8a42 · Hard

Iraqi artist Nazik Al-Malaika, celebrated as the first Arabic poet to write in free verse, didn't reject traditional forms entirely; her poem "Elegy for a Woman of No Importance" consists of two ten-line stanzas and a standard number of syllables. Even in this superficially traditional work, _____blank Al-Malaika was breaking new ground by memorializing an anonymous woman rather than a famous man.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. therefore,

B. in fact,

C. moreover,

D. though,

2.88 87812ea4-9d3b-4381-9f09-9e3b8c2ea327 · Hard

Many historical accounts of the 1930s focus on the widespread movement of people from dust bowl–ravaged Great Plains states to faraway California. However, a 2016 study of 1940 census data complicates this popular narrative; _____blank researchers determined, migrants in states hardest hit by prolonged droughts and dust storms—Colorado, Kansas, Oklahoma, and Texas—merely relocated within the region.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. for this reason,

B. more often,

C. additionally,

D. nevertheless,

2.89 c956956e-cfea-4723-b4c0-78b3b2301076 · Hard

In a heated debate in biogeography, the field is divided between dispersalists and vicariancists. _____blank there are those who argue that dispersal is the most crucial determining factor in a species' distribution, and those who insist that vicariance (separation due to geographic barriers) is. Biogeographer Isabel Sanmartín counts herself among neither.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Furthermore,

B. By contrast,

C. Similarly,

D. That is,

2.90 02e8a6bd-5ee6-4963-a33f-b583deda3645 · Hard

Long thought to be sessile (immobile), adult *Chelonibia testudinaria*, barnacles that adhere to sea turtle shells, have been observed to shift slightly in position over time—a phenomenon that has been attributed to the barnacles' passive displacement by water currents. _____blank a research team found that adult *C. testudinaria* moved toward the heads of their sea turtle hosts and thus against the prevailing water flow, behavior consistent with self-initiated locomotion.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Contrary to this phenomenon,

B. Undermining this explanation,

C. Drawing a similar conclusion,

D. Confirming this hypothesis,

2.91 61864769-d20c-41fd-bd1a-b4b0540127bb · Hard

A team of ornithologists documented patterns of conspecific brood parasitism among wood ducks (*Aix sponsa*) in California. The researchers observed several female wood ducks visiting dozens of nesting sites and laying eggs to be incubated by other nesting *A. sponsa*. Subject 7F64B, _____blank visited a select few nesting sites before laying and incubating her eggs herself.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. in particular,

B. alternatively,

C. for example,

D. similarly,

2.92 305de7e7-1899-4dd5-a658-e651cf87c5c3 · Hard

The Sun and other stars are powered by nuclear fusion reactions, in which two atoms collide to form a single heavier atom, releasing energy. Scientists have long believed that fusion has the potential to meet humanity's clean energy needs. _____blank prior to December 2022, no fusion reaction in a laboratory setting had ever generated a net energy gain.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. For this reason,

B. Moreover,

C. Specifically,

D. That said,

2.93 a06f47da-7544-430d-9c92-a51c690bef56 · Hard

In the late twentieth century, scholars directed much discussion toward issues of spatiality. Adherents to quantitative analytical approaches delineated space with the use of GIS spatial technologies; _____blank cultural geographer Doreen Massey defined space as the product of “an ever-shifting social geometry of power and signification,” focusing instead on socio-political forces.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. for example,

B. by contrast,

C. as such,

D. likewise,

2.94 3cb17aea-6417-4349-92c8-01f629ddd643 · Hard

If the formation of Earth’s mantle had been purely a product of core differentiation—whereby heavier elements sink toward the core and lighter elements rise—the upper mantle would be depleted of heavy siderophile elements. Siderophiles are much more abundant in the mantle than predicted in that model, however. _____blank extraterrestrial material containing siderophiles, likely from asteroid or comet impacts, almost certainly accreted to Earth following core differentiation.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. That said,

B. Hence,

C. For example,

D. Likewise,

2.95 544458e0-8ddf-44f9-afc2-94b9af641d31 · Hard

A staunch supporter of women's voting rights, Wilhelmina Kekelaokalaninui Widemann Dowsett sought to coordinate the efforts of suffragists in her native Hawai'i. _____blank in 1912, she founded the National Women's Equal Suffrage Association of Hawai'i, an organization that lobbied for women's voting rights in the US territory.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In other words,

B. Conversely,

C. To that end,

D. Alternatively,

2.96 950fb78f-3d1d-481f-8939-613de6443c4c · Hard

Modernista architects championed nature in their designs. _____blank the wavy staircase and ornate floral tilework of Hospital de Sant Pau, a Modernista hospital designed by Lluís Domènech i Montaner, couldn't exactly grow in a forest. Still, one sees natural influences in Domènech i Montaner's penchant for curves (rather than right angles) and plant- and animal-inspired flourishes.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Furthermore,

B. Similarly,

C. Of course,

D. Thus,

2.97 f830b98a-f26c-4665-9abb-e89265908b38 · Hard

When designing costumes for film, American artist Suttirat Larlarb typically custom fits the garments to each actor. _____blank for the film *Sunshine*, in which astronauts must reignite a dying Sun, she designed a golden spacesuit and had a factory reproduce it in a few standard sizes; lacking a tailor-made quality, the final creations reflected the ungainliness of actual spacesuits.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Nevertheless,

B. Thus,

C. Likewise,

D. Moreover,